

HOUSE No. 4900

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, January 8, 2026.

The committee on Financial Services, to whom was referred the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1319) of Adam J. Scanlon, James B. Eldridge and James K. Hawkins relative to insurance coverage for comprehensive clinical and extended support services, reports recommending that the accompanying bill (House, No. 4900) ought to pass.

For the committee,

JAMES M. MURPHY.

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The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act related to comprehensive clinical and extended support services.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 17N of chapter 32A of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after the definition of “Clinical stabilization
3 services” the following definition:-

4 “Transitional support services”, short-term, residential support services, as
5 defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services,
6 which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the
7 addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery
8 care.

9 SECTION 2. Section 17N of chapter 32A of the General Laws, as so appearing, is
10 hereby further amended by striking out the fourth paragraph and inserting in place thereof the
11 following paragraph:-

12 The commission shall provide for medically necessary acute treatment services,
13 medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support

14 services to an active or retired employee of the commonwealth who is insured under the group
15 insurance commission coverage for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to
16 obtaining such acute treatment services, clinical stabilization services or transitional support
17 services. The facility providing such services shall notify the carrier of admission and the initial
18 treatment plan within 48 hours of admission, and within a reasonable time thereafter, shall
19 provide the carrier with a projected discharge plan for the member. The carrier's utilization
20 review procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided, however, that a carrier shall not make
21 any utilization review decisions that impose any restriction or deny any future medically
22 necessary acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional support services unless a patient
23 has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services; and, provided further, that the
24 commission shall provide, without preauthorization, to any active or retired employee of the
25 commonwealth who is insured under the group insurance commission coverage for substance use
26 disorder evaluations ordered pursuant to section 51½ of chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification
27 by the admitting facility and receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the
28 treating clinician and member to offer care management and support services.

29 Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation
30 with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

31 SECTION 3. Section 10H of chapter 118E of the General Laws, as appearing in
32 the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby repealed.

33 SECTION 4. Said chapter 118E, of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby
34 further amended by inserting after section 10Z the following section:-

Section 10AA. For the purposes of this section, the following words shall have the following meanings unless the context clearly requires otherwise:

“Acute treatment services”, 24-hour medically supervised addiction treatment for adults or adolescents provided in a medically managed or medically monitored inpatient facility, as defined by the department of public health, which provides evaluation and withdrawal management and that may include biopsychosocial assessment, individual and group counseling, psychoeducational groups and discharge planning.

“Clinical stabilization services”, 24-hour clinically managed post detoxification treatment for adults or adolescents, as defined by the department of public health, usually following acute treatment services for substance abuse for individuals beginning to engage in recovery from addiction, which may include intensive education and counseling regarding the nature of addiction and its consequences, relapse prevention, outreach to families and significant others and aftercare planning, for individuals beginning to engage in recovery from addiction.

“Transitional support services”, short-term, residential support services, as defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services, which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery care.

The division and its contracted health insurers, health plans, health maintenance organizations, behavioral health management firms and third-party administrators under contract to a Medicaid managed care organization or primary care clinician plan shall cover the cost of

medically necessary acute treatment services and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining treatment.

The division and its contracted health insurers, health plans, health maintenance organizations, behavioral health management firms and third-party administrators under contract to a Medicaid managed care organization or primary care clinician plan shall cover the cost of medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support services for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining clinical stabilization services or transitional support services. The facility providing such services shall notify the carrier of admission and the initial treatment plan within 48 hours of admission and within a reasonable time thereafter shall provide the carrier with a projected discharge plan for the member. The carrier's utilization review procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided, however, that a carrier shall not make any utilization review decisions that impose any restriction or deny any future medically necessary acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional support services unless a patient has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services; and, provided further, that the division and its contracted health insurers, health plans, health maintenance organizations, behavioral health management firms and third party administrators under contract to a Medicaid managed care organization or primary care clinician plan shall cover, without preauthorization, substance use disorder evaluations ordered pursuant to section 51½ of chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification by the admitting facility and receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the treating clinician and member to offer care management and support services.

Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

79 SECTION 5. Section 47GG of chapter 175 of the General Laws, as appearing in
80 the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after the definition of “Clinical
81 stabilization services” the following definition:-

82 “Transitional support services”, short-term, residential support services, as
83 defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services,
84 which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the
85 addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery
86 care.

87 SECTION 6. Section 47GG of chapter 175 of the General Laws, as so appearing,
88 is hereby further amended by striking out the fourth paragraph and inserting in place thereof the
89 following paragraph:-

90 Any policy, contract, agreement, plan or certificate of insurance issued, delivered
91 or renewed within the commonwealth, which is considered creditable coverage under section 1
92 of chapter 111M, shall provide coverage for medically necessary acute treatment services,
93 medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support
94 services for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining acute
95 treatment services, clinical stabilization services or transitional support services. The facility
96 providing such services shall provide the carrier notification of admission and the initial
97 treatment plan within 48 hours of admission and within a reasonable time thereafter shall provide
98 the carrier with a projected discharge plan for the member. The carrier’s utilization review
99 procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided, however, that a carrier shall not make any
100 utilization review decisions that impose any restriction or deny any future medically necessary

acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional support services unless a patient has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services; provided further, any policy, contract, agreement, plan or certificate of insurance issued, delivered or renewed within the commonwealth, which is considered creditable coverage pursuant to section 1 of chapter 111M, shall cover, without preauthorization, a substance use disorder evaluation ordered pursuant to section 51½ of chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification by the admitting facility and receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the treating clinician and member to offer care management and support services.

Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

SECTION 7. Section 8II of chapter 176A, of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after the definition of "Clinical stabilization services" the following definition:-

"Transitional support services", short-term, residential support services, as defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services, which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery care.

SECTION 8. Section 8II of chapter 176A of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by striking out the fourth paragraph and inserting in place thereof the following paragraph:-

Any contract between a subscriber and the corporation under an individual or group hospital service plan that is delivered, issued or renewed within the commonwealth shall provide coverage for medically necessary acute treatment services, medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support services for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining acute treatment services, clinical stabilization services or transitional support services. The facility providing such services shall provide the carrier notification of admission and the initial treatment plan within 48 hours of admission and within a reasonable time thereafter shall provide the carrier with a projected discharge plan for the member. The carrier's utilization review procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided, however, that a carrier shall not make any utilization review decisions that impose any restriction or deny any future medically necessary acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional support services unless a patient has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services; provided further, any contract between a subscriber and the corporation under an individual or group hospital service plan that is delivered, issued or renewed within the commonwealth, shall cover, without preauthorization, a substance use disorder evaluation ordered pursuant to section 51½ of chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification by the admitting facility and receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the treating clinician and member to offer care management and support services.

Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

SECTION 9. Section 4II of chapter 176B of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after the definition of "Clinical stabilization services" the following definition:-

“Transitional support services”, short-term, residential support services, as defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services, which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery care.

SECTION 10. Section 4II of chapter 176B of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by striking out the fourth paragraph and inserting in place thereof the following paragraph:-

Any subscription certificate under an individual or group medical service agreement delivered, issued or renewed within the commonwealth shall provide coverage for medically necessary acute treatment services, medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support services for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining acute treatment services, clinical stabilization services or transitional support services. The facility providing such services shall provide the carrier notification of admission and the initial treatment plan within 48 hours of admission and within a reasonable time thereafter shall provide the carrier with a projected discharge plan for the member. The carrier’s utilization review procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided, however, that a carrier shall not make any utilization review decisions that impose any restriction or deny any future medically necessary acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional support services unless a patient has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services; provided further, any subscription certificate under an individual or group medical service agreement delivered, issued or renewed within the commonwealth shall provide coverage for, without preauthorization, a substance use disorder evaluation ordered pursuant to section 51½ of

chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification by the admitting facility and receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the treating clinician and member to offer care management and support services.

Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

SECTION 11. Section 4AA of chapter 176G of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after the definition of "Clinical stabilization services" the following definition:-

"Transitional support services", short-term, residential support services, as defined by the department of public health, usually following clinical stabilization services, which provide a safe and structured environment to support adults or adolescents through the addiction recovery process and the transition to outpatient or other step-down addiction recovery care.

SECTION 12. Section 4AA of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by striking out the fourth paragraph and inserting in place thereof the following paragraph:-

An individual or group health maintenance contract that is issued or renewed shall provide coverage for medically necessary acute treatment services, medically necessary clinical stabilization services and medically necessary transitional support services for up to 30 days and shall not require preauthorization prior to obtaining acute treatment services, clinical stabilization services or transitional support services. The facility providing such services shall provide the carrier notification of admission and the initial treatment plan within 48 hours of admission and

190 within a reasonable time thereafter shall provide the carrier with a projected discharge plan for
191 the member. The carrier's utilization review procedures may be initiated on day 14; provided,
192 however, that a carrier shall not make any utilization review decisions that impose any restriction
193 or deny any future medically necessary acute treatment, clinical stabilization or transitional
194 support services unless a patient has received at least 30 consecutive days of said services;
195 provided further, an individual or group health maintenance contract that is issued or renewed
196 shall provide coverage for, without preauthorization, a substance abuse evaluation ordered
197 pursuant to section 51½ of chapter 111. Upon receipt of notification by the admitting facility and
198 receipt of the discharge plan, the carrier may provide outreach to the treating clinician and
199 member to offer care management and support services.

200 Medical necessity shall be determined by the treating clinician in consultation
201 with the patient and noted in the patient's medical record.

202 SECTION 13. The center for health information and analysis, in consultation with
203 the division of insurance, the department of public health, the office of Medicaid and the health
204 policy commission, shall conduct reviews on the 14 day mandated coverage of acute treatment
205 services, clinical stabilization services and the long-term effects of the increase in covered days
206 from 14 days to 30 days related to the mandated benefits for acute treatment services, clinical
207 stabilization services and transitional support services on the following areas: (i) the continuum
208 of care for substance use disorder treatment; (ii) access to the continuum of care for patients
209 eligible for MassHealth and department of public health programs; (iii) access to the continuum
210 of care for commercially insured patients; and (iv) any changes in costs to MassHealth, the
211 department of public health and health insurance carriers. The center shall provide an initial
212 report not later than October 1, 2026 on the effects of the 14 day mandated coverage of acute

213 treatment services and clinical stabilization services to the areas listed above and a final report
214 not later than October 1, 2028 on the effects of the 30 day mandated coverage of acute treatment
215 services, clinical stabilization services and transitional support services to the areas listed above.

216 The initial report and final report shall be posted on the center's website and shall
217 be filed with the clerks of the house of representatives and senate, the house and senate chairs of
218 the committee on financial services, the house and senate chairs of the committee on health care
219 financing, the house and senate chairs of the committee on public health and the house and
220 senate committees on ways and means not later than October 1, 2026 and October 1, 2028,
221 respectively.

222 SECTION 14. Sections 1 through 12, inclusive, shall take effect October 1, 2026.